first is that it gives an incorrect result for an empty string:

```
countWords '', ':'
# 1
```

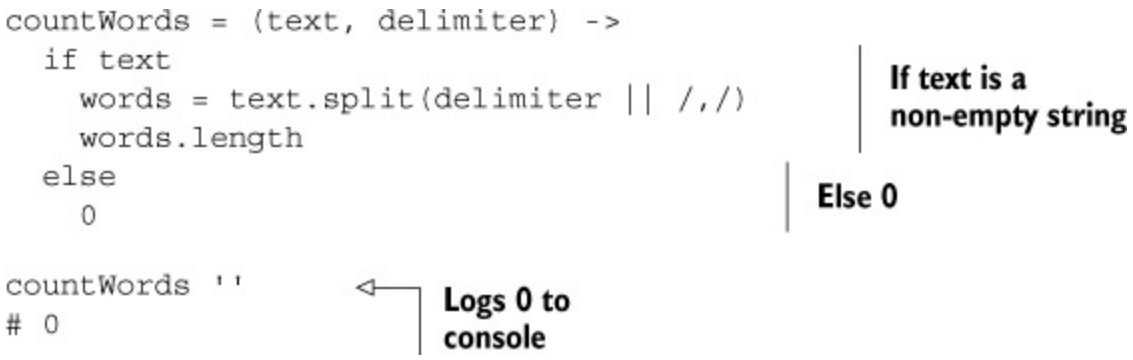
It does that because that's how the `split` method works. Normally for `countWords`, the way that `split` works is fine for a single word:

```
'abc'.split /,/
# ['abc']
```

But an empty string looks just like a single word:

```
''.split /,/
# ['']
```

To fix the empty string problem in `countWords`, add an `if` inside it to check whether the text argument is empty or not:



How does this affect the last expression in the function body? It now depends on whether the `if` or the `else` branch is evaluated. If the string is empty, then the `else` branch is evaluated[1] and the last expression is `0`. If the string is not empty, then the `if` branch is evaluated and the last expression is `words.length`.

[1] The `else` branch is evaluated when `text` is an empty string because an empty string is a falsy value. Remember, the falsy values are `null`, `false`, `0`, and `''`.

Explicit return statement